



TIPS & TRICKS

Stop any running process by using the command prompt

 We can stop any process that is not responding by using the following method.

Run the command given below to know the PID (Process ID) of the application that you want to stop.

```
#top
```

While the above command is running, press *k*. This will prompt you to give the PID of the process you want to stop/kill.

```
PID to Kill:
```

You need to give the PID and press *Enter* to kill the process. After you have done that, press *q* to exit back to the output of the top command.

—Vinay Khandalkar,
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Get a list of logged-in users with the date and time

 Using the *who* and *cut* commands, one can get the list of the logged-in users with the time and date of logging in.

```
# who | cut -d " " -f1,12
```

In the above command, we redirect the output of *who* to the *cut* command.

Who will give you the list of the logged-in users on the computer and the *cut* command with the *-d* options and a space (" ") delimiter will separate the fields.

Also *-f1,11,12* gives the 1st, 11th and 12th fields of the output.

```
king 2012-05-18 14:27  
ntest 2012-05-18 14:27
```

Here it shows the username, date and time.

—Chirag K Gohel,
chiragkgohel@gmail.com

Use the *time* command as a stopwatch

 Open a terminal and run the following command:

```
~$time read
```

Now press *CTRL + D* to stop the command and view its output:

```
~$ time read  
real 0m3.000s  
user 0m0.000s  
sys 0m0.000s
```

Here, the *real* timing is the time between the start and the stopping of the command. This can be used as a stop watch to calculate timing.

The command below can be used to stop the clock using any key on the keyboard instead of *CTRL+D*:

```
time read -sn1
```

—Ajinkya Jiman,
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System calls generated by command

 Here is a simple command that will give you the details of the system calls generated by a command.
Open a terminal and run the following command:

```
~$strace -c ls >/dev/null
```

You can read the manual page of *strace* for more details on this.

—Shashank Diwan,
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